

OpenClaw Switch Models

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1. Course Content

This course will systematically introduce OpenClaw's model selection working mechanism and three model switching operation methods.

2. Temporarily Switch Session Model

2.1 Open TUI Session

- Enter in terminal

```
openclaw tui
```

2.2 Use /model to Switch Session Model

Command	Description
<code>/model</code>	View available model list, select and switch model

- Enter `/model` in the conversation box, for example, select and switch to `bailian/qwen3.5-plus`, use the up and down arrow keys on the keyboard to select a model, then press Enter

```
openclaw tui - ws://127.0.0.1:18789 - agent main - session main  
  
session agent:main:main  
connected | idle  
agent main | session main (openclaw-tui) | bailian/glm-4.7 | tokens ?/203k
```

```
search: >   
  
→ bailian/glm-4.7  
bailian/glm-5  
bailian/kimi-k2.5  
bailian/MiniMax-M2.5  
bailian/qwen3-coder-next  
bailian/qwen3.5-plus  
bailian/qwen3.6-plus  
bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23  
bailian/qwen3-coder-plus
```

3. Switch Default Model

3.1 Switch via CLI

The simplest way is to use the CLI command to set the default model directly:

- Here, take switching to `bailian/qwen3.6-plus` model as an example

```
openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.6-plus
```

```
Updated ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json  
Default model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus  
jetson@vabhoom:~$
```

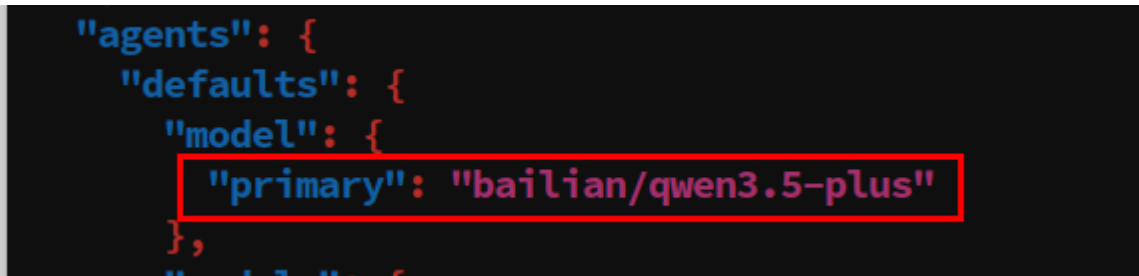
3.2 Switch via Configuration File

- Edit the `openclaw.json` configuration file to modify the Agent's default model

```
nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json  
# Or use your favorite editor, such as vim, code, etc.
```

In `openclaw.json`, specify the default primary model through the `agents.defaults.model.primary` configuration item:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      }
    }
  }
}
```



```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
    }
  }
}
```

- Verify if the configuration takes effect:

```
openclaw models status
```

```
Before runtime loads
Config       : ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Agent dir    : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
Default      : bailian/qwen3.5-plus
Fallbacks (0) : -
Image model   : -
Image fallbacks (0): -
Aliases (0)   : -
Configured models (9): bailian/qwen3.5-plus, bailian/qwen3.6-plus, bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23, bailian/qwen3-coder-next, bailian/qwen3-coder-plus, bailian/MiniMax-M2.5, bailian/glm-5, bailian/glm-4.7, bailian/kimi-k2.5
```

4. Add Model Options List

- `agents.defaults.models` is the **allowlist/directory** that controls the usable model range in OpenClaw. When this configuration item is set, users can only use models included in the list. This list serves as the basis for model range control for both the `/model` command and session overrides.

4.1 Add Models via Configuration File

Configure `agents.defaults.models` in `openclaw.json` and add models that need to be used to the allowlist:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      },
      "models": {
        "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},

```

```

    "bailian/qwen3.6-plus": {},
    "bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
    "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
    "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
    "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
    "bailian/glm-5": {},
    "bailian/glm-4.7": {},
    "bailian/kimi-k2.5": {}
  }
}
}
}

```

```

"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.6-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3.6-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "bailian/glm-5": {},
      "bailian/glm-4.7": {},
      "bailian/kimi-k2.5": {}
    }
  }
}

```

4.2 Add Models via CLI Command

Using the `openclaw config set` command can safely edit the allowlist without manually modifying the JSON file:

```
openclaw config set agents.defaults.models '{"openai/gpt-5.4":{}}' --strict-json --merge
```

Parameter Description:

- `--strict-json`: Strict JSON mode, ensuring correct input format
- `--merge`: Merge mode, merging new configuration with existing configuration instead of completely overwriting

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.6-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3.6-plus": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-next": {},
      "bailian/qwen3-coder-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "bailian/glm-5": {},
      "bailian/glm-4.7": {},
      "bailian/kimi-k2.5": {},
      "openai/gpt-5.4": {}
    }
  },
}
```

4.3 Model Reference Format Specification

In OpenClaw, all model references use a unified format:

Provider/Model ID

Examples:

Model Reference	Description
anthropic/claude-opus-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Opus model
anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Sonnet model
openai/gpt-5.4	OpenAI's GPT-5.4 model
openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2	Case where the model ID itself contains a slash

Note: If the model ID itself contains / (such as moonshotai/kimi-k2), you must provide the complete reference in the format openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2.

5. Appendix: CLI Command Quick Reference

Command	Purpose
<code>openclaw onboard</code>	Beginner guide, helping to quickly complete initial configuration
<code>openclaw models list</code>	View all configured model lists
<code>openclaw models status</code>	View current model configuration status details
<code>openclaw config set agents.defaults.models '<json>' --strict-json --merge</code>	Safely add models to the allowlist
<code>/model</code>	View available model list in chat
<code>/model status</code>	View current model status details in chat